

Tanuja Paunikar

Product Designer

Pune, India · Remote preferred, open to relocation for the right role · Available immediately

I've been a product designer for over ten years. I started in a Mumbai studio doing client work, then spent four years as the only designer on three SaaS products used across 3M+ sites, working with the founder, engineers, growth, and content, and mentoring other designers as we went. For the last two years I've also been shipping my own products by directing AI coding agents. One is on the App Store, one is open source. I don't stop at Figma anymore.

3 SaaS products on one design system · 60+ releases with design QA · 2M to 3M+ installs during my tenure · 4.7/5 across 5,000+ reviews · 3 products shipped independently

Skills

End-to-end product design. First idea to shipped, with the process fitted to the problem: research first, a few directions to compare, or one final design when the call is clear. Prototypes get built in code so stakeholders try the real thing, then go out for feedback, or, on my own products, all the way to shipping.

User research. Interviews, usability tests, support tickets, reviews, and funnel analytics, before any design starts. All of it shows up in the work.

Design systems. A decade of them: studio clients across product, marketing, and brand, one system shared by three SaaS products that engineers chose to use, and lately in code so AI tools build inside the rules. Knowing when to follow, bend, or grow one is the job.

AI-native workflow. Designed in Figma, built with Claude Code, Codex, and Cursor. System first so everything stays consistent, every output checked before it ships. Batch, an open source tool that lets AI agents work from notes, came out of this workflow.

Accessibility & platforms. The responsive web and iPhone, working for everyone: accessible by default, careful type, motion that calms down when asked.

Leadership & collaboration. Led design for three brands, founder-direct. Quality held on 60+ releases, designers coached through critique, four years async with a US team. Ready to manage one.

Experience

Awesome Motive

Apr 2021 to Dec 2025

Remote, US-based team

UI/UX Designer (AIOSEO, LowFruits, SEOBoost)

SaaS product company, globally distributed team

First designer at AIOSEO, WordPress's most-installed SEO plugin (3M+ sites), owning product UI, the design system, and visual direction across the brand and its acquisitions, LowFruits and SEOBoost. Reported directly to the founder, no PM in between, working cross-functionally with engineering, content, and growth in Agile delivery.

- Built one design system from zero, tokens, components, variants, and documentation, extended it to both acquisitions, and got engineers with no time for a system to adopt it.
- Designed the full self-serve funnel, install, onboarding, configuration, upgrade, and checkout, with no sales call, and iterated it on funnel data with the growth team.
- Designed flagship features: TruSEO in-context content scoring, an AI assistant for titles and FAQs, a visual schema builder for structured data, Search Console reporting, site audit and monitoring dashboards, and SEOBoost's data-heavy keyword research UX.
- Designed marketing and growth surfaces, landing, pricing, lifecycle, and launch pages, in step with product releases.
- Ran user research myself, interviews, usability testing, support-ticket and review mining, and funnel analysis, and turned findings into shipped work. Design QA and sign-off on 60+ releases.
- Contributed to growth from 2M to 3M+ installs, with the product holding 4.7/5 across 5,000+ reviews. Mentored designers across brands through structured critique.

Freelance & Independent Practice

Feb 2020 to present

Remote, India

Product Designer and Builder

First alongside full-time work, full-time since 2025

Product design practice with engagements through referrals, from client dashboards and apps to complete products designed and shipped end to end.

- **Orime** (2026, live on the App Store): native iOS rewards app. Decision-first home that shows only what needs a decision now, points-versus-cash slider with earn-back shown up front, automatic right-card recommendation. SwiftUI, design system encoded in the codebase, through App Review.
- **HealthFirst** (2026): fully built healthcare web app on React and Laravel. Multi-role permissions, patient intake, multi-member profiles, admin review, and insurance pre-authorization, accessible on a documented component system.
- **Batch** (2026, open source, MIT): macOS app for AI-assisted work in React, TypeScript, and Tauri, with an MCP server so coding agents act on notes, 74 tests, signed and notarized releases.
- Client work across finance dashboards, sports platforms, reading apps, and video archives, shipped as the only designer, including empty states, error flows, and store assets, with complex role-based workflows modelled into clear interfaces.

Bokaap Design

Feb 2016 to Apr 2021
Mumbai, on-site

UI/UX Designer

Design studio for global early and growth-stage clients

Led product, web, and brand engagements end to end, shaping strategy with founders.

- Led design end to end on Sevasadan, FootageFarm, GEPL Capital, and Itara among others, from discovery and user research through information architecture, interaction design, UI, prototyping, and launch.
- Shaped product strategy with founders and PMs: scoped MVPs, prioritised roadmaps by user impact, and defined what shipped in v1 versus later.
- Built design systems adopted across product, marketing, and brand, cutting handoff time and unifying every touchpoint into one experience.
- Ran usability testing, stakeholder interviews, and client workshops, presenting work from ambiguous first brief to final delivery.
- Partnered with engineering through implementation and design QA, owning pixel-level fidelity and accessibility from Figma to production.

How I work with AI

Prototypes used to end in Figma; now they ship. I lock the design system first, then direct **Claude Code**, **Codex**, and **Cursor** to build one flow at a time, reviewing every output before it moves on. The tools produce, I decide, and a working prototype is on real data in days, not weeks.

Tools

Design: Figma, expert level, components, variables, Dev Mode, prototyping · Adobe CS.
Build: Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, GitHub. **Motion:** GSAP, Motion. **Collaboration:** Jira, Notion, Slack, Google Workspace.

I try every new design tool the week it ships, Rive, Spline, Paper, Reve, Claude Design included, and keep what earns its place.

Get in Touch

Looking for full-time, remote work at a place where design owns outcomes, not just deliverables. Strong bias for product teams building something genuinely ambitious.

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